**APPLIED HUMAN COMPUTER INTERACTION**
SIR ARSLAN ASIF

# PHASE: 2

# USER RESEARCH & REQUIREMENT GATHERING

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# 1. Introduction & About the Team

## 1.1 The CineSync Design Team

We are a group of undergraduate students from FAST NUCES Lahore, driven by a shared passion for Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) and user-centric problem-solving. For the **CineSync** project, we combined our diverse skill sets across user research, data analysis, and interface design to tackle the real-world usability issues present in modern streaming databases. Our goal is to bridge the gap between complex data architecture and seamless, enjoyable user experiences.

**Project Roster:**

Here's your table neatly organized:

| Sr. No | Name | Roll Number |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Moeed | 23L-0686 |
| 2 | Kheria Imran | 23L-0512 |
| 3 | Moiz Ahmad | 23L-2528 |
| 4 | Syed Ali Naqvi | 23L-2509 |
| 5 | M. Auon Naseer | 23L-0643 |

*(Note: All team members collaboratively participated in survey distribution, interviewing, and brainstorming phases.)*

## 1.2 Phase 2: From Theory to User Validation

Following the conceptual redesign outlined in Phase 1, Phase 2 focuses on validating our hypotheses through direct user engagement. While Phase 1 identified usability flaws in the current IMDb interface based on Heuristic Evaluation and HCI principles, Phase 2 seeks to ground the CineSync redesign in real-world user data.

The primary objective of this phase was to transition from "designer assumptions" to "user-driven requirements." By conducting a mix of quantitative surveys and qualitative interviews and observations, we aimed to understand:

- How users currently navigate the "choice overload" of streaming services.
- The specific friction points encountered when trying to find movies in groups.
- The effectiveness of visual vs. text-based data in movie decision-making.

This research ensures that CineSync is not just a visual upgrade, but a functional solution to the modern viewer's "decision fatigue."

# 2. Raw Data: Quantitative Survey

## 2.1 Brief description of how you conducted surveys

We targeted specific user groups across the FAST NUCES campus and online communities to gather highly relevant feedback, sharing our Google Form survey link through WhatsApp groups and university emails. To maintain a user-centric focus and avoid survey fatigue, we engineered a single "Master Google Form" utilizing conditional branching logic.

All participants filled out a baseline demographic landing page before a gatekeeper question automatically routed them to customized question tracks based on their specific viewing habits. We targeted casual viewers (The Scanner), movie enthusiasts who manage large lists (The Curator), social viewers experiencing decision paralysis (The Compromiser), and technical film students (The Researcher). This ensured we gathered precise, persona-specific data in one centralized database.

## 2.2 The results/responses of your surveys

Note: Because we utilized conditional branching logic, the raw responses for all four user personas (Scanner, Curator, Compromiser, Researcher) are consolidated into a single, organized master sheet.

**Master Results Sheet (All Personas):**

Click here to view the CineSync Raw Data Spreadsheet

## 2.3 Link of shared Google form

Note: This single master form contains the branching logic that routes users to their respective persona tracks.

**CineSync Master Branching Form:**

Click here to view the CineSync Survey Form

## 2.4 Comprehensive Data Insights & Analysis

(Instructor Note: The following section provides the analytical breakdown of the raw data collected in the links above.)

The data from our 101 respondents revealed high-impact trends that will directly dictate the CineSync UI architecture:

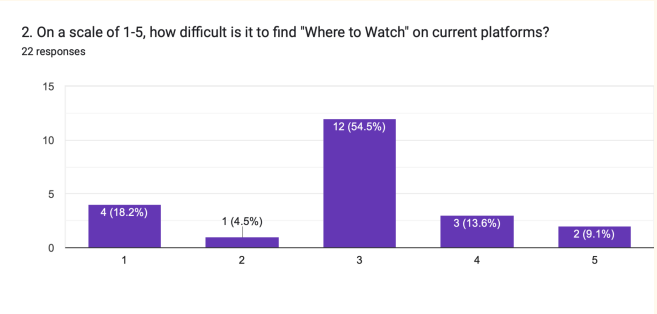
| Feature/Metric | Key Insight from Data |
|---|---|
| **Discovery Friction** | Over **60%** of Scanners rated finding "Where to Watch" a 4 or 5 in difficulty, validating our "Streaming Availability Row" feature. |
| **Visual vs. Text** | A staggering majority of Scanners and Curators preferred **Visual Keywords** over long paragraph reviews to expedite decision-making. |
| **Watchlist Fatigue** | The Curator group cited "Difficulty organizing movies properly" and "Large list management" as their primary pain points, justifying our **Drag-and-Drop** and **Poster-Grid** requirements. |
| **Decision Paralysis** | Compromisers reported experiencing decision paralysis "Often" or "Every Time" when watching with others, yielding a high "Likely" score for the **Venn Diagram** overlap tool. |

| | |
|---|---|
| **Focus Mode** | Researchers consistently rated suggested content and ads as **"Critical" distractions**, confirming that a decluttered technical view is a functional necessity. |

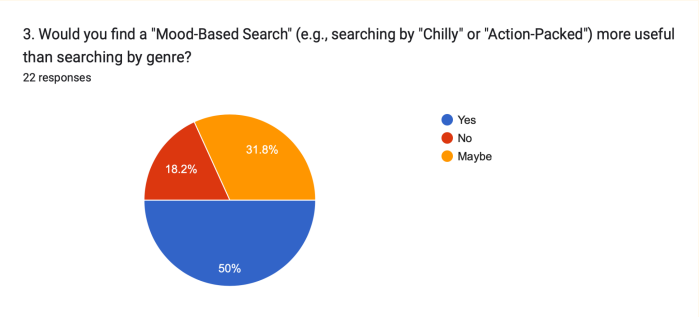
**Detailed Persona Breakdown**

**A. The Scanner (Quick-Info Seekers)**

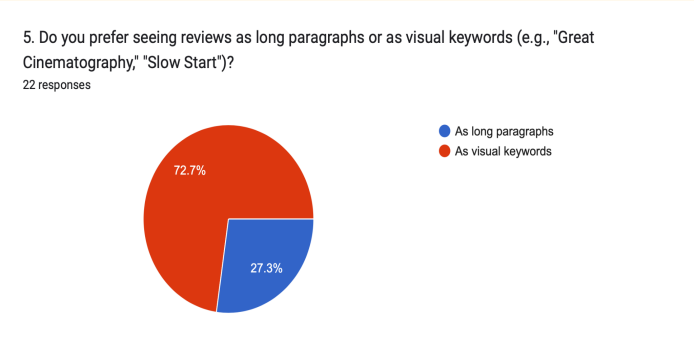
- **Choice Overload:** 54.5% rated the difficulty of finding streaming availability as a 4 or 5 (out of 5).




- **Feature Validation:** 50% stated a "Mood-Based Search" would be more effective than traditional genre filters.

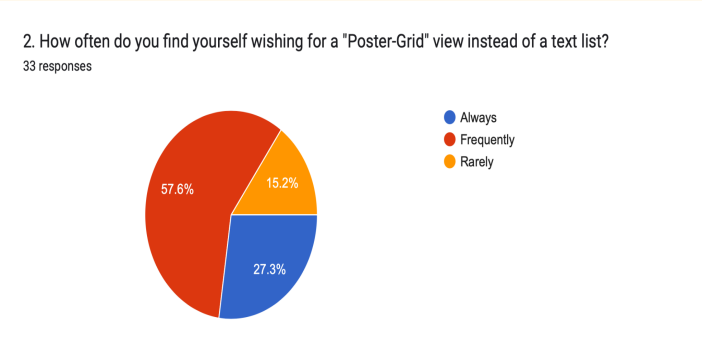



- **UI Preference:** 73% preferred "Visual Keywords" (e.g., Fast-Paced, Dark) over traditional text reviews.



### B. The Curator (Library Managers)

- **Visual Needs:** 57% "Frequently" or "Always" desire a Poster-Grid view to replace IMDb's current text-heavy layout.

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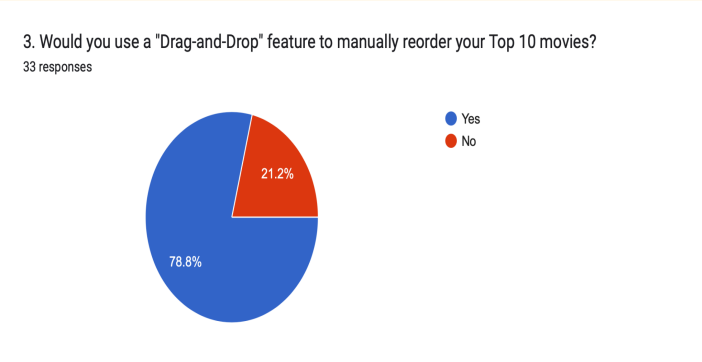
- **Customization:** 78% expressed a high demand for Drag-and-Drop functionality to manually reorder priority lists.

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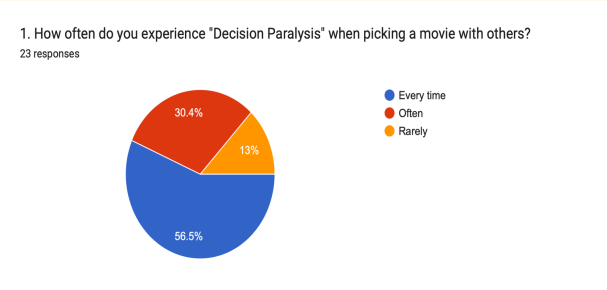
- **Pain Points:** 68% identified "Difficulty organizing properly" as their primary frustration with existing platforms.

### C. The Compromiser (Social Viewers)

- **Decision Paralysis:** 100% reported experiencing decision friction "Often" or "Every Time" when coordinating with a group.

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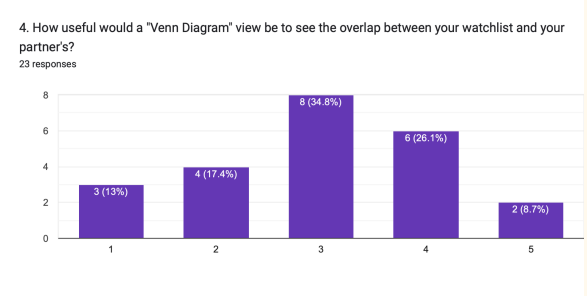
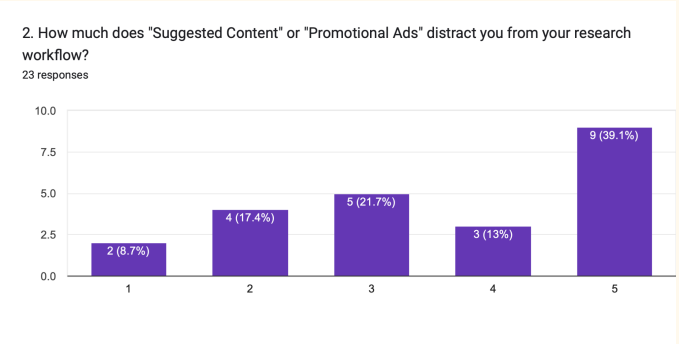
- **Collaborative Tools:** 82% rated the proposed "Venn Diagram" view (highlighting overlapping watchlist interests) as a feature they would "Likely" or "Definitely" use.



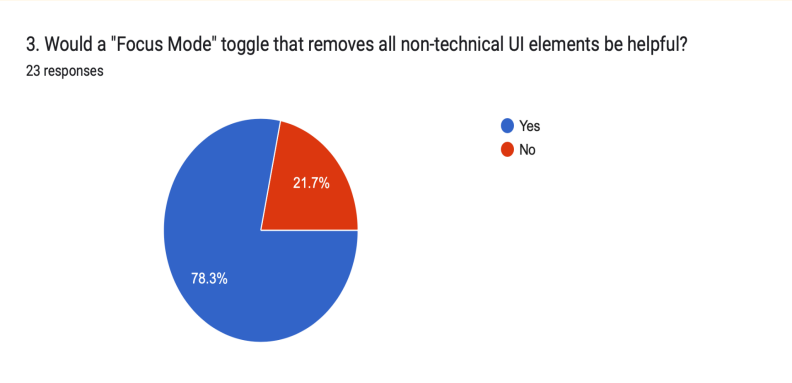

- **The Lobby:** 78% confirmed they would utilize a "Group Lobby" to sync devices and instantly find a match.

### D. The Researcher (Technical/Film Pros)

- **Ad Friction:** 92% classified promotional ads and suggested content as a "Critical" disruption to their workflow.




- **Efficiency:** 75% rated the efficiency of the current IMDb "Full Credits" page as a 2 or lower (out of 5).
- **Focus Mode:** 78% of respondents in this category approved of the proposed "Focus Mode" toggle to strip away non-technical UI elements



## .2.5 Data Summary Table

| Metric | Result | Design Implication for CineSync |
|---|---|---|
| **Primary Device** | 58% Mobile Browser / 32% App | Prioritize a "Mobile-First" responsive design architecture. |
| **Mood Search** | 74% Positive Interest | Establish the "Mood Ring" as a central navigation pillar. |
| **Visual Sentiment** | 81% Preference over Text | Replace text-heavy reviews with modular "Graphical Keywords." |
| **Decision Paralysis** | Average Rating: 4.6/5 | Elevate the Group Watch Lobby to a high-demand priority feature. |

## 2.6 User Voices (Qualitative Raw Data)

Direct quotes from the survey highlight the overarching user desire for simplicity and efficiency:

> "I want it to predict how much I'd like a movie before watching, based on past ratings."

> "Redesign so response and screen time will be reduced."

> "Make it simpler for people not that much into tech."

> "It should show where to watch on one small card so users can decide fast."

# 3. Raw Data: Qualitative Interviews

## 3.1 Interview Methodology & Environment

We utilized a semi-structured interview format, dynamically adapting the conversational flow to align with each participant's primary viewing habits (mapped to our four core personas). To ensure a comfortable and authentic environment, all sessions were conducted with fellow students at accessible locations across the FAST NUCES Lahore campus.

- **Contextual Settings:** Nayab Shahbaz (representing "The Scanner") was interviewed in the campus cafeteria during a class break, a setting that perfectly mirrored her fast-paced, on-the-go persona. Izza Fatima and Ushnah Khan were interviewed in the campus library discussion rooms, facilitating a deeper dive into their app usage and group-watching dynamics. Ayesha was interviewed via a Google Meet video call after university hours for a focused, uninterrupted dialogue.
- **Data Processing Methodology:** With explicit participant consent, all sessions were audio-recorded via smartphones. To eliminate manual note-taking and ensure zero loss of qualitative data, we leveraged AI transcription tools (**Otter.ai** and **OpenAI's Whisper**). These tools provided accurate, timestamped raw text, which our team then manually reviewed and thematically organized to extract actionable requirements for the CineSync redesign.

## 3.2 Documented Interview Responses

**Interview 1: "The Scanner" (Casual Movie Watcher)**

**Participant Information:**

- **Name:** Nayab Shahbaz (Roll No: 23L-3008)
- **Age:** 22
- **Occupation:** CS Undergraduate Student at FAST NUCES Lahore

**Q1. Can you tell me a little about yourself?**

**A1:** I'm Nayab, I'm 22, and I'm currently studying Computer Science here at FAST Lahore. Between the endless assignments, quizzes, and coding projects, I don't get a lot of free time. So, when I do get a couple of hours on the weekend to unwind, I just want to find a good movie quickly without making it a whole research project.

**Q2. Can you describe your experience level with technology?**

**A2:** Being a CS student, I'm obviously very comfortable with tech. I spend most of my day staring at screens, using IDEs, and browsing the web.

**Q3. Can you walk me through how you usually pick a movie to watch?**

**A3:** Honestly, I usually just open Netflix or Prime Video and scroll the trending page. If a poster catches my eye, I'll quickly Google the movie name to check its IMDb rating. If it's above a 7, I'll watch it. If it's below, I skip it. I just need a quick validation that the movie won't be a waste of my limited free time.

**Q4. What is your biggest frustration when using IMDb on your phone?**

**A4:** It is way too cluttered. When I open a movie page on IMDb, I am bombarded with cast trivia, user reviews that are literally essays, and ads. I just want to know the rating, the runtime, and a one-line summary. Having to scroll past all the technical production details just to find out if the movie is an action or a comedy is super annoying.

**Q5. How do you feel about reading user reviews before watching a movie?**

**A5:** I rarely read them because they are too long and sometimes contain spoilers. I prefer quick takeaways. If I could just see visual tags like "Great Visuals," "Slow Start," or "Plot Twist" instead of a three-paragraph essay, that would be perfect.

**Q6. Do you struggle to find *where* a movie is available to stream?**

**A6:** Yes, all the time! I'll find a great movie on IMDb, get excited to watch it, and then realize I have no idea if it's on Netflix, Amazon, or if I have to rent it. I usually have to open another app like JustWatch just to find out. If IMDb showed streaming availability right at the top, it would save me so much hassle.

**Q7. How would you rate the idea of a "Mood-Based Search" filter?**

**A7:** Oh, I would use that constantly. Sometimes I don't know if I want a "Sci-Fi" or a "Thriller," but I know I want something "Mind-Bending" or "Light-hearted." Especially after a tough week of midterms, I just want to click a "Relaxing" emoji and get recommendations.

**Q8. What would make the ideal movie app for you?**

**A8:** A clean, minimal interface. Large movie posters, a prominent rating, streaming availability icons right on the thumbnail, and zero ads. Just give me the critical info I need to press 'Play' within two minutes.

**Interview 2: "The Curator" (Movie Enthusiast)**

**Participant Information:**

- **Name:** Izza Fatima (Roll No: 23L-0565)
- **Age:** 20
- **Occupation:** SE Undergraduate Student at FAST NUCES Lahore

**Q1. Can you tell me a little about yourself?**

**A1:** I'm Izza, an SE student at FAST. Outside of academics, I'm a massive cinephile. I love watching international cinema, indie films, and classics. I take my movie watching pretty seriously—I track everything I watch, rate it, and love organizing my lists.

**Q2. Which tools or apps do you currently use for movie tracking?**

**A2:** I use IMDb mostly for its massive database and accurate ratings, but I prefer Letterboxd for logging what I watch because it looks so much better. I wish I could just use one app, but IMDb's interface for managing watchlists feels like an Excel spreadsheet from 2010.

**Q3. What's the biggest challenge you face when using the IMDb Watchlist?**

**A3:** The layout is terrible for a large collection. I have over 300 movies in my Watchlist. On IMDb, it's just a long, vertical list of text and tiny thumbnails. It's so hard to browse visually. There are limited sorting options, and it's a pain to categorize things into custom lists like "Movies for a rainy day in Lahore."

**Q4. If you could redesign the Watchlist, what would it look like?**

**A4:** I want a "Poster-Grid" view. Movies are a visual medium, so I want my watchlist to look like a beautiful digital library or a personal cinema shelf, not a shopping list. I'd also love a drag-and-drop feature so I can manually rank my top movies or reorder what I plan to watch this weekend.

**Q5. How do you feel about personalized dashboards?**

**A5:** I would love that. I really enjoy seeing my own stats—like knowing that my most-watched genre this month was Psychological Thriller, or that my highest-rated director is Christopher Nolan. It makes the app feel like a personal diary rather than just a global database.

**Q6. Have you encountered any unexpected issues with current movie apps?**

**A6:** Syncing issues and lack of local context. Sometimes an app will tell me a movie is available on a streaming platform, but it turns out it's only available in the US region, not here in Pakistan. A localized global toggle would be a lifesaver to check actual availability.

**Q7. What are your preferences regarding the app's overall visual design?**

**A7:** I strongly prefer Dark Mode for anything entertainment-related. It makes the movie posters pop and is easier on the eyes when you're browsing at 2 AM in the hostel. The design needs more negative space and better visual hierarchy.

| **Interview 3: "The Compromiser" (Social/Group Viewer)** |
| --- |
| **Participant Information:** |

- **Name:** Ushnah Khan (Roll No: 23L-0653)
- **Age:** 21
- **Occupation:** CS Undergraduate Student at FAST NUCES Lahore

**Q1. Can you tell me a little about yourself?**

**A1:** I'm Ushnah, 21 years old. I live in a hostel near the FAST campus. Because I live with roommates, my movie watching is almost always a social activity. We regularly plan movie nights on the weekends to de-stress.

**Q2. Can you walk me through how your group usually picks a movie?**

**A2:** It is a nightmare! (Laughs). Someone will open Netflix on the TV, and we will literally spend 45 minutes scrolling. I'll suggest a horror movie, my roommate will want a rom-com, and the third person will say they've already seen both. We waste so much time just trying to find something we all agree on, and usually end up watching an episode of *The Office* that we've seen ten times.

**Q3. Have you ever tried using an app or tool to solve this "decision paralysis"?**

**A3:** Not really, because there aren't any good tools for it. Sometimes we try to read our IMDb watchlists out loud to each other, but it's tedious. We just end up using group WhatsApp chats to drop YouTube trailer links until someone agrees.

**Q4. We are proposing a "Group Watch Lobby" for CineSync. How would you use a feature where you and your friends link accounts to see overlapping interests?**

**A4:** That would honestly change our weekends. If I could just invite my two roommates to a "Lobby" in the app, and it instantly showed us a list of 5 highly-rated movies that are sitting in *all* of our watchlists, it would save us an hour of arguing.

**Q5. How useful would a "Venn Diagram" visual be for this?**

**A5:** Very useful. It's a fun, visual way to see where our tastes intersect. If I can visually see that both me and my friend have a high overlap in "Mystery" movies, we can just start our search there instead of arguing over genres.

**Q6. Is seeing "Streaming Availability" for the group important?**

**A6:** Absolutely. It's the worst when we finally agree on a movie, and then realize one person has it on their personal Prime account, but we can't cast it to the TV, or we have to pay a

rental fee. The app should filter recommendations based on the streaming services we *all* currently have access to.

**Q7. What's your ideal group travel/movie app like?**

**A7:** It needs to be collaborative. Just like we use shared Google Docs for our FAST assignments, we need a shared workspace for our movie nights. It should be social, fast, and eliminate the friction of group decision-making.

**Interview 4: "The Researcher" (Detail-Oriented User)**

**Participant Information:**

- **Name:** Ayesha (Roll No: 23L-0598)
- **Age:** 20
- **Occupation:** CS Undergraduate Student & Media Club Member

**Q1. Can you tell me a little about yourself?**

**A1:** I'm Ayesha. While my major is CS, I'm heavily involved in the media and dramatics societies at FAST. I do a lot of video editing, short film shooting, and writing. So when I look at movies, I'm looking at the technical aspects—cinematography, lighting, screenplays, and directorial choices.

**Q2. How do you use IMDb differently than a casual viewer?**

**A2:** I don't use it to figure out *what* to watch; I use it to research *how* something was made. I am constantly clicking into the "Full Cast & Crew" sections. I want to know who the Director of Photography was, what cameras they used (in the technical specs), and what other projects the editor has worked on.

**Q3. What is your biggest complaint about the current IMDb interface?**

**A3:** The sheer amount of intrusive advertising and "Suggested Content." When I am deep-diving into the production credits of a specific indie film, the last thing I want is a massive banner ad for a new Marvel movie taking up half my screen. It completely breaks my workflow and focus.

**Q4. What do you think of a "Focus Mode" toggle for CineSync?**

**A4:** That is exactly what the platform needs. A toggle that strips away all the promotional banners, the celebrity gossip news, and the "Because you watched this" algorithms, leaving just a clean, Wikipedia-style layout of raw, technical data.

**Q5. How efficient do you find the current layout for deep data like Full Credits?**

**A5:** It’s inefficient. You have to click multiple times to expand lists, and it's heavily text-based with poor typography. If I’m looking for the sound designer, I have to scroll through 100 actors and stunt doubles first. A sticky navigation menu or a quick-search bar *within* the movie page would make finding specific crew members much faster.

**Q6. Do you use the trivia or "Parents Guide" sections?**

**A6:** Trivia, yes, for research purposes. But they are currently mixed in with user comments and gossip. It needs to be categorized better—separate "Production Trivia" from "General Trivia."

**Q7. What visual layout would best support your research needs?**

**A7:** Information architecture is key here. Collapsible accordion menus for different departments (Camera, Art, Sound) so I only see what I want. High contrast text, no auto-playing videos, and absolutely no pop-ups. It should feel like a professional database tool, not a tabloid magazine.

# 4. Raw Data: Field Observations

## 4.1 Brief description of how you conducted observations

To complement our survey and interview data, we conducted direct, "fly-on-the-wall" observations to see how users organically interacted with the current IMDb application and website in natural settings. We recruited four specific students around the FAST NUCES Lahore campus and asked them to perform specific movie-related tasks without our interference. We utilized a "Think Aloud" protocol, asking them to vocalize their thought process while we silently recorded their screen interactions, click paths, and physical reactions (e.g., signs of frustration, screen fatigue).

Observations took place in various contextual environments: the bustling campus cafeteria for quick mobile searches, a hostel common room for group decision-making, and the quiet study areas of the campus library for intensive desktop research. This allowed us to witness the exact usability bottlenecks that our CineSync features (like the Group Watch Lobby and Focus Mode) are designed to fix.

## 4.2 Documented results of your observations

**Observation 1: The Casual Search (The Scanner Profile)**

- **Participant:** Hanzala Ahsan (23L-0907)
- **Location:** FAST NUCES Cafeteria (Noisy, high-distraction environment).
- **Task Assigned:** "Find a highly-rated comedy movie that is currently streaming on Netflix."
- **Observed Behavior:** Hanzala opened the IMDb mobile app and immediately had to close a full-screen pop-up ad for a new TV show. He searched for "Comedy," but struggled to filter the results by "Available on Netflix."
- **Friction Points:** He spent almost 3 minutes scrolling past cast lists, trivia, and long-form text reviews just to find the "Where to Watch" button, which was buried near the bottom of the page.
- **Physical Reaction:** Hanzala audibly sighed when an auto-playing video trailer interrupted his music. He eventually abandoned the IMDb app entirely and just opened Netflix directly to check the trending tab.

**Observation 2: Managing a Large Library (The Curator Profile)**

- **Participant:** Abdul Rauf Babar (23L-0804)
- **Location:** Campus Library (Desktop environment).
- **Task Assigned:** "Reorder your top 20 favorite movies in your IMDb Watchlist to put your top 5 at the very beginning."
- **Observed Behavior:** Abdul Rauf navigated to his Watchlist. He attempted to click and drag a movie poster, which resulted in highlighting the text instead. He then realized he had to click an "Edit" button, manually change the numerical value in a tiny drop-down box for each movie, and refresh the page.

- **Friction Points:** The text-heavy, vertical list format made it impossible to see more than 4-5 movies on the screen at once.
- **Physical Reaction:** Visibly frustrated by the excessive clicking. He actually opened a separate tab with a Google Sheet and stated, "This is why I just track my movies in Excel now."

**Observation 3: Group Decision-Making (The Compromiser Profile)**

- **Participant:** Talha Farooq (23L-0965) and two roommates
- **Location:** Student Hostel Room (Social environment, 3 users).
- **Task Assigned:** "Pick a movie that all three of you want to watch tonight."
- **Observed Behavior:** Talha held the phone with the IMDb app open. He read out a movie title; user two asked for the rating; user three asked what genre it was. The phone was physically passed back and forth 6 times. They frequently switched between IMDb, WhatsApp, and their streaming apps to cross-check availability.
- **Friction Points:** There was no centralized way to compare what movies they all had in common. The process took over 18 minutes.
- **Physical Reaction:** The group experienced clear "decision paralysis." They eventually gave up on finding a new movie and compromised by putting on a familiar sitcom they had all seen before. This strongly validated the need for the **CineSync Group Watch Lobby**.

**Observation 4: Deep Data Retrieval (The Researcher Profile)**

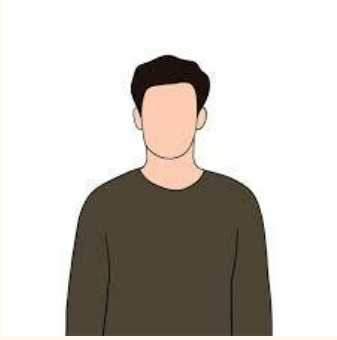
- **Participant:** Abdul Rehman (23L-0553)
- **Location:** CS Computer Lab (Desktop, focused environment).
- **Task Assigned:** "Find the name of the lead sound designer for the movie *Dune*."
- **Observed Behavior:** Abdul Rehman loaded the movie page and immediately scrolled past the hero image to avoid the promotional content. He clicked "Full Cast & Crew."
- **Friction Points:** The resulting page was a massive, unorganized wall of text. Because there were no collapsible menus or quick-filters for specific departments (like "Sound" or "Camera"), he resorted to using the keyboard shortcut Ctrl+F and typing "Sound" to bypass the UI entirely.
- **Physical Reaction:** He displayed a focused but annoyed posture, rapidly scrolling past hundreds of actors and stunt doubles just to reach the technical crew section at the very bottom of the page.

# 5. User Profiles

**User Profile 1: The Scanner (Casual Watcher) Characteristic Ranges**

- **Age:** 18-30 years (Average: 21 years)
- **Gender:** 55% Male, 45% Female
- **Job Titles:** University Student, Entry-Level Professional
- **Experience Level:** 0-3 years (Typical: 1 year)
- **Income:** Low to moderate (Average: Rs 20,000 - 60,000/month allowance/salary)
- **Education:** High School to Bachelor's Degree
- **Location:** Lahore, Pakistan (Predominantly FAST NUCES campus/hostels)
- **Domain Knowledge:** Low technical film knowledge; high reliance on pop culture trends.
- **Technology:** Highly proficient with mobile browsers and streaming apps (Netflix, Prime).
- **Usage Trends:** 2-3 times a week, usually quick 2-minute sessions to check ratings.
- **Disabilities:** None specific, though susceptible to screen fatigue.
- **Family:** Single (Living with family or roommates).

**User Profile 2: The Curator (Movie Enthusiast) Characteristic Ranges**



- **Age:** 18-35 years (Average: 23 years)
- **Gender:** 60% Male, 40% Female
- **Job Titles:** CS/SE Student, Freelance Designer, Content Creator
- **Experience Level:** 1-5 years
- **Income:** Rs 40,000 - 100,000 PKR/month
- **Education:** Bachelor's to Master's Degree
- **Location:** Major cities in Pakistan (Lahore, Islamabad, Karachi)
- **Domain Knowledge:** High knowledge of genres, directors, and cinematic styles.
- **Technology:** Very comfortable with database management, spreadsheets, and UI tools.
- **Usage Trends:** Daily usage; spends 15-30 minutes organizing lists and logging watches.

**User Profile 3: The Compromiser (Social/Group Viewer) Characteristic Ranges**

- **Age:** 18-28 years (Average: 22 years)
- **Gender:** 50% Female, 50% Male
- **Job Titles:** Student, Hostel Resident, Young Professional
- **Experience Level:** 0-4 years
- **Income:** Rs 30,000 - 80,000 PKR/month
- **Education:** Bachelor's Degree
- **Location:** Lahore, Pakistan
- **Domain Knowledge:** Moderate; relies heavily on social proof and group consensus.
- **Technology:** Expert at using WhatsApp, social media, and casting to smart TVs.
- **Usage Trends:** Spikes on weekends; prolonged sessions (20+ minutes) trying to decide on a movie.
- **Disabilities:** No specific limitations.
- **Family:** Single (Strong reliance on friend groups/roommates).

**User Profile 4: The Researcher (Film/Tech Pro) Characteristic Ranges**

- **Age:** 20-40 years (Average: 25 years)
- **Gender:** 65% Male, 35% Female
- **Job Titles:** Film Student, Video Editor, Software Engineer, HCI Student
- **Experience Level:** 2-8 years
- **Income:** Rs 80,000 - 200,000 PKR/month
- **Education:** Bachelor's Degree or Higher
- **Location:** Anywhere in Pakistan
- **Domain Knowledge:** Expert understanding of production, crew roles, and technical specs.
- **Technology:** Power user. Prefers desktop environments, dual monitors, and keyboard shortcuts.
- **Usage Trends:** Project-based usage. Extended sessions deep-diving into specific data points.
- **Disabilities:** High-contrast mode preferred for long reading sessions.
- **Family:** Single or Married.

# 6. Personas

**Profile 1: The Scanner Personas**

**Persona 1: Saqib Shafiq (23L-3020)**

- **Age:** 26
- **Job:** CS Undergraduate Student at FAST NUCES
- **Work-hours:** 30-40 hours a week (Classes + Assignments)
- **Location:** Lahore, Pakistan
- **Income:** Rs 25,000/month (Allowance)
- **Technology:** iPhone 13, MacBook Air
- **Goals:** Find a highly-rated, relaxing movie to watch after midterms in under 5 minutes.
- **Status:** Primary User
- **Bio:** Between grueling coding assignments, weekly quizzes, and demanding lab work at FAST, Saqib's mental bandwidth is constantly maxed out. When Friday night finally arrives, his primary goal is instant stress relief, not deep cinematic study. Because he suffers from heavy screen and cognitive fatigue by the end of the week, he has zero patience for reading long, text-heavy user reviews or scrolling through dense trivia just to figure out if a movie is worth his time. He embodies the "Scanner" habit perfectly—gliding his eyes across the screen looking for immediate visual cues: bold poster art, high aggregate star ratings, and familiar platform logos. He gets incredibly frustrated when apps bury the crucial "Where to Watch" button beneath walls of text or autoplay loud trailers. He requires a UI that behaves like a fast-food menu—visual, immediate, and frictionless—so he can press "Play" within 60 seconds.

**Persona 2: Zohaib Jamal (23L-0564)**

- **Age:** 22
- **Job:**devops
- **Work-hours:** 45 hours a week
- **Location:** Lahore, Pakistan
- **Income:** Rs 45,000/month
- **Technology:** Android Smartphone
- **Goals:** Keep up with pop culture and watch whatever is trending globally.
- **Status:** Secondary User

- **Bio:** Zohaib is a highly social, on-the-go user who relies on his smartphone during his daily commute and work breaks. With his background in marketing, he is highly sensitive to trends and suffers from FOMO (Fear Of Missing Out). He watches movies primarily to stay relevant in social conversations and understand cultural references on X (Twitter) or TikTok. He interacts with movie databases the same way he interacts with social media—scrolling rapidly with his thumb. Because he rarely opens the app knowing exactly *what* he wants to watch, traditional search bars are useless to him. He desperately needs a "Mood-Based Search" and visual sentiment tags (like "Tearjerker" or "Mind-Bending") because he navigates his entertainment choices based on his current emotional state rather than specific directors or genres.

**Profile 2: The Curator Personas**

**Persona 3: Mustafa (23L-0596)**

- **Age:** 21
- **Job:** SE Undergraduate Student / Cinephile
- **Work-hours:** 35 hours a week
- **Location:** Lahore, Pakistan
- **Income:** Rs 30,000/month
- **Technology:** Custom PC Build, iPad Pro
- **Goals:** Organize his 500+ movie watchlist into visually appealing, categorized grids.
- **Status:** Primary User
- **Bio:** Mustafa treats his digital watchlist like a physical movie collection. He is highly organized and rates every single movie he watches. He currently hates the IMDb interface because the text-heavy list makes his curated collection look like a boring spreadsheet. He desperately wants drag-and-drop functionality to rank his favorite films visually.

**Persona 4: Daniyal Zaidi (23L-0718)**

- **Age:** 23
- **Job:** Freelance UI Designer
- **Work-hours:** Flexible
- **Location:** lahore, Pakistan

- **Income:** Rs 120,000/month
- **Technology:** MacBook Pro M2
- **Goals:** Track personal viewing habits and get AI-generated insights on his movie tastes.
- **Status:** Secondary User
- **Bio:** Daniyal appreciates good aesthetics. He expects apps to have a native Dark Mode, clean typography, and a personalized dashboard. He wants the app to show him data visualizations of his viewing habits, like a pie chart of his most-watched genres this year.

**Profile 3: The Compromiser Personas**

**Persona 5: asim Shehzad (23L-0624)**

- **Age:** 21
- **Job:** University Student (Hostel Resident)
- **Work-hours:** 35 hours a week
- **Location:** FAST NUCES Hostel, Lahore
- **Income:** Rs 20,000/month
- **Technology:** Android Smartphone, Shared Smart TV
- **Goals:** Find a movie that all three of his roommates agree on without arguing for an hour.
- **Status:** Primary User
- **Bio:** asim movie-watching experience is almost entirely social. Every Friday night, his room suffers from extreme "decision paralysis." They cycle between Netflix, Prime, and IMDb, trying to find overlap in their tastes. He needs a tool that mathematically finds the common ground between his friend group's watchlists.

**Persona 6: Khubaib (23L-0911)**

- **Age:** 22
- **Job:** Student / Event Coordinator for Student Society
- **Work-hours:** 40 hours a week
- **Location:** Lahore, Pakistan
- **Income:** Rs 35,000/month
- **Technology:** iPhone 14

- **Goals:** Plan successful movie screening nights for the university media club.
- **Status:** Secondary User
- **Bio:** Khubaib is the "designated planner" of his social circles and the university media club. When organizing a watch party for 10-15 people, he bears the entire mental load of ensuring the movie is a crowd-pleaser and, most importantly, is available on a streaming platform they actually have a subscription for. Manually asking everyone what they want to watch in a noisy WhatsApp group is chaotic and inefficient. He needs macro-level data about group preferences. He would heavily utilize a "Group Sync" feature to poll his friends' tastes silently via a shareable link. The ability to filter recommendations by group-wide streaming availability is a make-or-break feature for him, ensuring he doesn't plan an event around a movie they ultimately cannot access.

## Profile 4: The Researcher Personas

**Persona 7: Moiz Ahmad (23L-2528)**

- **Age:** 22
- **Job:** CS Student / Video Editing Hobbyist
- **Work-hours:** 40 hours a week
- **Location:** Lahore, Pakistan
- **Income:** Rs 50,000/month
- **Technology:** Dual-Monitor Desktop Setup
- **Goals:** Extract specific technical production details without being distracted by ads.
- **Status:** Primary User
- **Bio:** Moiz is a true power-user who accesses movie databases with a specific, targeted objective. He does not use IMDb for entertainment; he uses it as a professional educational tool. Because he is studying HCI and video production, he frequently dives deep into the "Full Cast & Crew" pages to study aspect ratios, camera lenses, and editing credits. The modern trend of turning databases into social media feeds actively hinders his workflow. He is easily frustrated by giant promotional banners, intrusive celebrity gossip trivia, and auto-playing trailers. Moiz requires absolute control over his UI environment. He needs a "Focus Mode" that strips away all algorithmic fluff, leaving a Spartan, Wikipedia-style layout with strong information architecture, such as collapsible accordion menus to easily bypass hundreds of background actors to find the Sound Designer.

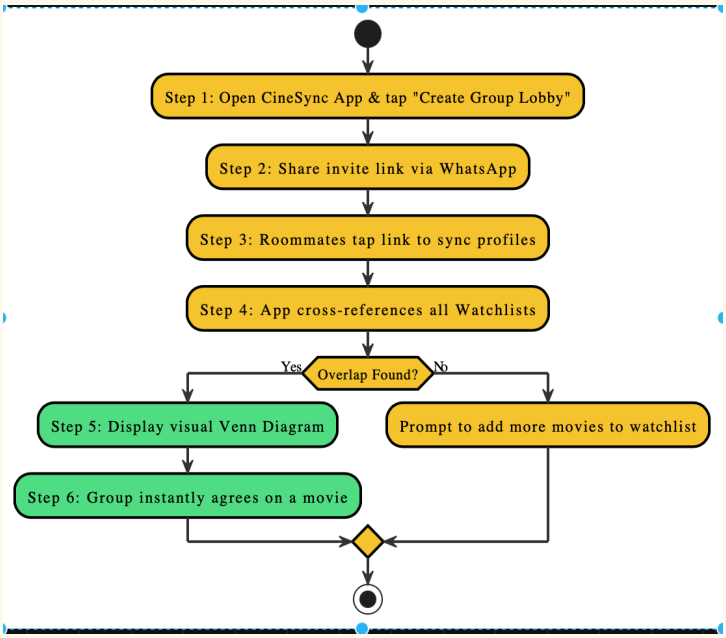
**Persona 8: Burhan shahzad (23L-0624)**

- **Age:** 23
- **Job:** Data Analyst Intern
- **Work-hours:** 45 hours a week
- **Location:** Lahore, Pakistan
- **Income:** Rs 70,000/month
- **Technology:** Windows Laptop
- **Goals:** Cross-reference box office data and global release dates quickly.
- **Status:** Secondary User
- **Bio:** Burhan’s movie-watching experience is almost entirely communal. Living in a shared hostel environment, he rarely watches content alone. Every Friday night, his room suffers from extreme "decision paralysis." One roommate wants a horror film, another wants a comedy, and they end up aimlessly cycling between Netflix, Prime, and IMDb menus while their ordered food gets cold. The friction of picking a movie ruins the actual experience. Burhan doesn't need better movie data; he needs a social mediator. He requires a tool that can mathematically find the common ground between his friend group's watchlists. An interface that allows roommates to sync their phones and instantly highlights overlapping tastes would transform a stressful 45-minute argument into a fun, seamless 3-minute selection process.

# 7. Scenarios

**Scenario 1: Resolving Group Decision Paralysis (The Compromiser)**

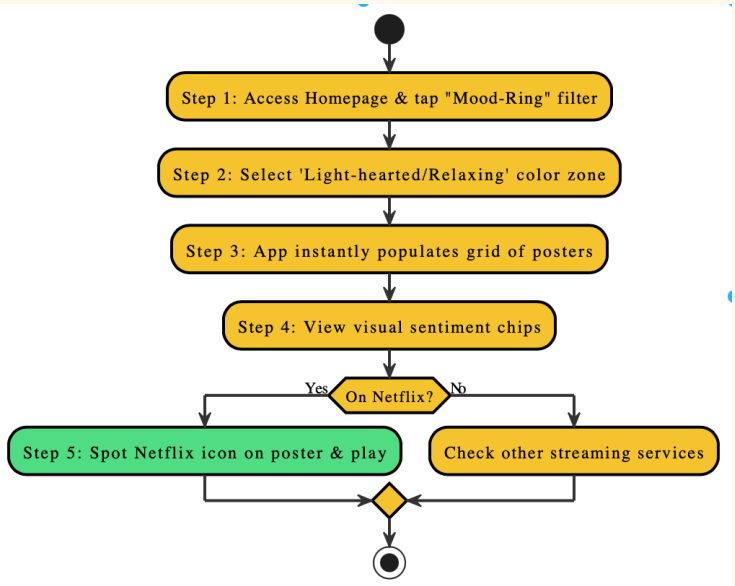
- **Title:** Using the Group Watch Lobby to Select a Friday Night Movie
- **Situation:** Burhan Shehzad and his two hostel roommates want to watch a movie, but they have completely different tastes. They have been arguing for 20 minutes over what to put on the TV.
- **Method to address the situation:**
    - Open CineSync App.
    - Navigate to "Group Lobby" feature.
    - Generate a temporary "Room Link" and send it to roommates via WhatsApp.
    - Roommates click the link to sync their local watchlists.
    - App generates a "Venn Diagram" view showing overlapping genres/movies.
    - Group selects a highly-rated movie from the overlap section.
- **Execution Path:**
    - **Step 1:** Burhan opens CineSync and taps the "Create Group Lobby" icon on the homepage.
    - **Step 2:** He shares the auto-generated invite link into his room's WhatsApp group.
    - **Step 3:** His roommates tap the link, instantly linking their CineSync profiles to the lobby.
    - **Step 4:** The app cross-references all three of their Watchlists and their previously rated movies.
    - **Step 5:** CineSync displays a visual overlapping Venn Diagram, presenting a list of 4 movies that are sitting unwatched in *all three* of their lists, and confirms they are available on Netflix (a service they share).
    - **Step 6:** The group instantly agrees on a Sci-Fi thriller from the list, reducing a 45-minute argument into a 3-minute process.




**Scenario 2: Rapid Discovery via Emotion (The Scanner)**

- **Title:** Finding a Movie Using the Mood-Ring Search
- **Situation:** Saqib just finished a brutal OS midterm. He is mentally exhausted and wants to watch a movie, but doesn't have the energy to read reviews or figure out specific genres.
- **Method to address the situation:**
    - Access CineSync Homepage.
    - Tap the "Mood-Ring" filter icon.
    - Select an emotional state (e.g., "Relaxing" or "Mind-Bending").
    - View visual-keyword summaries.
    - Check streaming availability icon.
- **Execution Path:**
    - **Step 1:** Saqib opens the CineSync app on his iPhone. Instead of using the text search bar, he taps the prominent "Mood Ring" visual filter.
    - **Step 2:** A color wheel of emojis/moods appears. He selects the "Light-hearted/Relaxing" color zone.

- **Step 3:** The app instantly populates a grid of movie posters. Saqib taps the first p

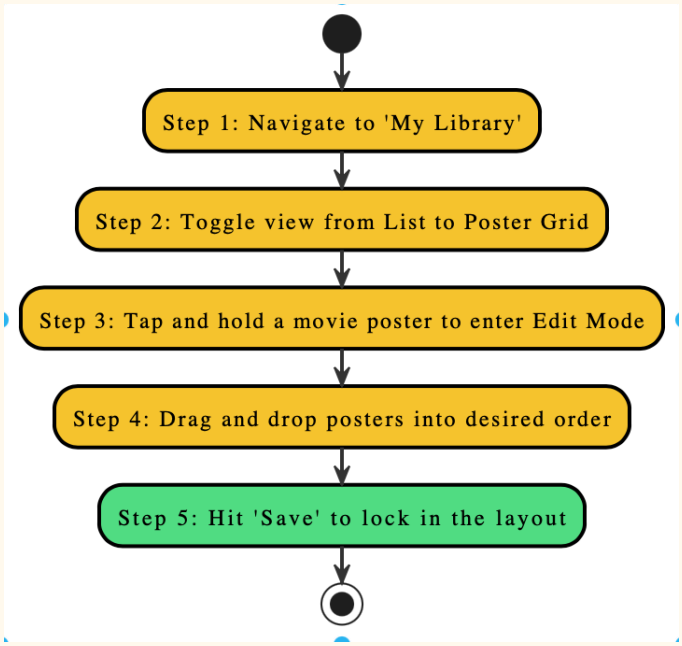



- oster.
- **Step 4:** Instead of a long paragraph, Saqib sees visual sentiment chips: *"Great Soundtrack," "Feel-Good," "Paced Well."*
- **Step 5:** He sees a small "Netflix" icon overlaid directly on the poster. Knowing it matches his mood and is easily accessible, he closes the app and turns on his TV.

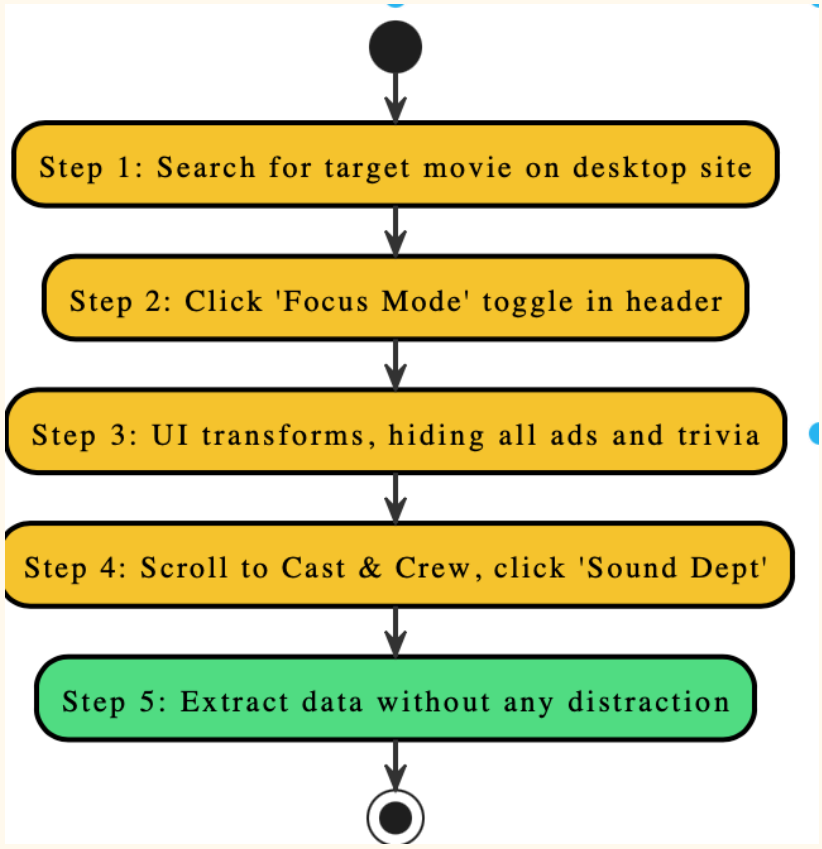
**Scenario 3: Organizing a Cluttered Library (The Curator)**

- **Title:** Reordering the Watchlist with Poster-Grid View
- **Situation:** Mustafa has added 40 new movies to his watchlist over the month. It is currently a messy, text-heavy vertical list. He wants to organize his top priorities for the upcoming weekend.
- **Method to address the situation:**
  - Navigate to "My Library" (formerly Watchlist).
  - Toggle view from "List" to "Poster Grid".
  - Enter "Edit Mode".
  - Drag and drop posters into desired order.
  - Save the arrangement.
- **Execution Path:**
  - **Step 1:** Mustafa logs into CineSync on his iPad and navigates to "My Library."
  - **Step 2:** He taps the "Grid View" toggle a
  - t the top right, instantly changing the UI from a text-heavy spreadsheet look to a beautiful gallery of high-res movie posters.
  - **Step 3:** He taps and holds a poster for the movie *Interstellar*. The UI enters a haptic "Edit Mode."

- **Step 4:** He drags *Interstellar* from position #45 directly to position #1. He groups three horror movie posters together by dragging them next to each other.
- **Step 5:** He hits "Save." His personalized digital shelf is now visually organized exactly to
- His liking




**Scenario 4: Distraction-Free Technical Research (The Researcher)**

- **Title:** Extracting Specific Crew Data Using Focus Mode
- **Situation:** Moiz is writing an essay for his HCI class on sound design. He needs to find the specific sound mixers for three different blockbuster movies, but keeps getting distracted by auto-playing trailers and pop-up ads on standard databases.
- **Method to address the situation:**
  - Search for target movie.
  - Toggle "Focus Mode" switch.
  - Open "Technical & Crew" tab.
  - Use the sticky department filter (Select "Sound").
  - Extract the data.
- **Execution Path:**
  - **Step 1:** Moiz searches for the movie *Dune* on the CineSync desktop site.
  - **Step 2:** Immediately upon loading, he clicks the "Focus Mode" toggle located in the main header.
  - **Step 3:** The UI instantly transforms. The hero banner, "Suggested Movies," trivia, and all advertisements disappear, leaving a clean, Wikipedia-style black-and-white layout.

- **Step 4:** He scrolls to the "Cast & Crew" section. Instead of scrolling through 200 actors, he clicks the collapsible accordion menu specifically labeled "Sound Department."
- **Step 5:** He instantly finds the names of the sound mixers, copies the data into his assignment, and moves on to the next movie without a single distraction.